

Inequality and Social Mobility - Presentation Teacher Guide

C2 · Ages Adults (20-23) · 90 min · Writing · + Critical Thinking

Presentation - teaching notes

Teacher copy. Keep this guide separate from the student PowerPoint. Slide numbers below refer to the numbered lesson slides; an exported slide may continue over several pages.

1. Inequality and Social Mobility

Evaluate causal claims, distinguish outcomes from mechanisms, and defend a conditional policy judgment.

Task: What do you already know about this topic?

Teacher note: Allow thinking time, then invite a response. Accept equivalent language that meets the objective.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

2. Today's goal

Write a nuanced policy analysis that separates causal hypotheses from evidence, weighs distributional trade-offs and specifies what would justify revision.

Task: Explain the goal in your own words.

Teacher note: Allow thinking time, then invite a response. Accept equivalent language that meets the objective.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

3. Look and discuss

What barriers to participation might exist beyond this scene?

Evaluate two ways to improve access without assuming anyone's circumstances.

Teacher note: Use this picture during the opening discussion. Accept different accurate responses. This is an illustrative scene, not evidence about real people or a substitute for the reading passage.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

Visual guidance: People arrive at an adult-learning center by bus and on foot; a parent accompanies a child and an adviser discusses a course.

4. inequality

inequality: An uneven distribution of resources, conditions or outcomes.

Inequality can persist even when a formal rule is equal.

Task: Use the word in a new example.

Teacher note: Model "inequality" with the supplied example. Check that learners distinguish the definition from an example.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

5. mobility

mobility: Movement between social or economic positions.

A mobility measure needs a defined comparison and period.

Task: Use the word in a new example.

Teacher note: Model "mobility" with the supplied example. Check that learners distinguish the definition from an example.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

6. systemic

systemic: Arising from the organization of connected institutions or practices.

A systemic barrier may persist without an explicit exclusion rule.

Task: Use the word in a new example.

Teacher note: Model "systemic" with the supplied example. Check that learners distinguish the definition from an example.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

7. opportunity

opportunity: A meaningful chance to pursue an outcome.

Opportunity depends partly on whether access is usable.

Task: Use the word in a new example.

Teacher note: Model "opportunity" with the supplied example. Check that learners distinguish the definition from an example.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

8. policy

policy: An organized course of action adopted by an institution.

A policy can have different effects on different groups.

Task: Use the word in a new example.

Teacher note: Model "policy" with the supplied example. Check that learners distinguish the definition from an example.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

9. Read and notice

Equal Eligibility, Unequal Access

Task: Why does the case not establish the cause of different participation rates?

Teacher note: Use the full reading printed in both worksheet versions. Check the four reading questions against the separate teacher key.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

10. Listen for details

The Evaluation Adviser's Caution

Task: Listen once for the situation, then again for details.

Teacher note: Use the supplied recording or read the exact script in the separate listening teacher copy. Do not display the transcript during the listening check.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

11. Useful language

- The observed association is consistent with ____, but cannot by itself establish ____.
- The policy's merits depend partly on how ____ is distributed and measured.
- Even if ____, it would not follow that ____; an alternative explanation is ____.

Task: Adapt one frame to the situation.

Teacher note: These are language models, not answers to the reading or listening questions.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

12. A policy hearing with a written dissent - 1

Council group: Recommend a limited package using the fictional case only. State whose access improves and who may remain excluded.

Task: Discuss your choice and explain your reason.

Teacher note: Use in the group activity. Use the fictional case, not classmates' family income or personal experiences. No external research is required; optional sources must be distinguished from the supplied evidence.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

13. A policy hearing with a written dissent - 2

Review group: Test the causal assumptions and administrative trade-offs. Do not treat a plausible mechanism as a measured effect.

Task: Discuss your choice and explain your reason.

Teacher note: Use in the group activity. Use the fictional case, not classmates' family income or personal experiences. No external research is required; optional sources must be distinguished from the supplied evidence.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

14. A policy hearing with a written dissent · 3

Final task: Write a joint recommendation and a short dissent that accurately represents the strongest unresolved objection.

Task: Discuss your choice and explain your reason.

Teacher note: Use in the group activity. Use the fictional case, not classmates' family income or personal experiences. No external research is required; optional sources must be distinguished from the supplied evidence.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.

15. Your final response

State your choice. Give evidence. Recognize a limitation.

Task: What would make you change your response?

Teacher note: Allow thinking time, then invite a response. Accept equivalent language that meets the objective.

Purpose: Build toward the stated learning objective.